

UMER SOHAIL

(302) 883-4521 • umersoha@udel.edu • umerssohail.com

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics , University of Delaware, Newark, DE	Expected August 2026
Fields: International Trade, Development Economics, Applied Microeconomics	
M.S. Economics and Applied Econometrics , University of Delaware, Newark, DE	May 2024
B.Sc. (Honors) Economics , Minor in Mathematics, LUMS, Lahore, Pakistan	May 2021

JOB MARKET PAPER

The Impact of Trade Liberalization on Manufacturing Firms: Evidence from Pakistan

with Shaheryar (Duke University) and Zehra Farooq (FBR, Pakistan) — Draft, July 2026

Author contributions: Umer Sohail developed the research question and empirical design, conducted the empirical analysis, and drafted the manuscript; coauthors facilitated access to the administrative data.

We study how manufacturing firms adjust to improved export-market access under the European Union's GSP+ agreement, which sharply reduced tariffs on Pakistani exports. Using administrative tax records linked to firm-level tariff exposure, we find substantial heterogeneity by baseline productivity: more productive firms expand capital investment and maintain employment, while less productive firms contract wage bills without reinvestment. Liberalization reallocates resources toward productive incumbents through within-firm restructuring rather than selection out of the market.

WORKING PAPERS

Causal Impact of Barter Trade Policy during a Foreign Exchange Reserves Crisis

with Fraz Ahmed (Carnegie Mellon University) — Draft, May 2026

When Pakistan's foreign exchange reserves collapsed in 2023, the government introduced a barter mechanism allowing goods-for-goods trade with Afghanistan, bypassing frozen banking channels. Using transaction-level customs data and product-level variation in barter eligibility, we show barter-eligible products experienced 30% higher export quantities during the crisis peak. Effects emerged during reserve depletion and dissipated as payment systems resumed, demonstrating that temporary interventions can sustain trade during payment system failures without persistent distortions.

Towards win-win: Evidence from commercial dispute resolution in India

with Manaswini Rao, Sandhya Seetharaman, and Raghav Pandey — Draft, November 2025

We study the effects of mediation in India using random assignment of cases to judges and a policy mandating mediation. Assignment to a settlement-prone judge increases dispute resolution and improves plaintiff firms' profitability, with effects persisting over time. Defendant firms experience a temporary decline in profits around settlement. The effects are strongest among firms involved in fewer cases, consistent with reduced uncertainty as a key mechanism.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record, University of Delaware, Newark, DE

Principles of Macroeconomics

Summer 2026

Economics Issues and Policies

Winter 2026

Teaching Assistant, University of Delaware, Newark, DE

Development Economics

Spring 2025

Banking and Monetary Policy

Fall 2024

Econometric Theory (graduate)

Spring 2024

Microeconomic Theory I (graduate)

Fall 2023

Teaching Assistant, Lahore University of Management Sciences (LUMS), Lahore, Pakistan

Macroeconomics

Fall 2021

Mathematical Applications in Economics

Spring 2021

Intermediate Microeconomics

Fall 2020

Econometrics

Spring 2020

SEMINARS AND CONFERENCES

Department Research Symposium, University of Delaware

Fall/Spring 2025, 2026

Brown Bag Seminar, University of Delaware

Spring 2026

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE**Research Assistant**, University of Delaware (Prof. Manaswini Rao)

June 2024 – Present

Constructed linked court and firm datasets and implemented judge-IV strategies in Stata and R.

Research Assistant, University of Delaware (Prof. Nisha Chikhale)

June – August 2025

Constructed longitudinal PSID panel for causal policy analysis with full replication files.

Research Assistant, University of Manchester, Manchester, UK

July – August 2021

Extracted and cleaned administrative tax records for quasi-experimental policy research.

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

Sally Latham Graduate Research Award, University of Delaware

2026

Graduated with Distinction, LUMS

2021

Dean's Honour List, LUMS

2018 – 2021

OTHER EMPLOYMENT**AI Automation Consultant**, TeamLift

September 2025 – July 2026

Designed and deployed workflow-automation systems for client organizations.

Data Researcher, Unison Infrastructure

August 2021 – July 2022

Built geospatial data pipelines from satellite imagery and administrative records to support infrastructure investment analysis.

SKILLS**Software:** Stata, R, Python, SQL, L^AT_EX, Git**Methods:** Causal Inference, Quasi-Experimental Design, Instrumental Variables, Difference-in-Differences**REFERENCES****Adriene Lucas** (Chair)Associate Professor of
Economics

University of Delaware

alucas@udel.edu

Parag MahajanAssistant Professor of
Economics

University of Delaware

paragma@udel.edu

Manaswini RaoAssistant Professor of
Economics

University of Delaware

manasrao@udel.edu

Shafaat Yar KhanAssistant Professor of
Economics

Syracuse University

skhan78@syr.edu